present view of the Government of India appears to be that recognition should be unconditional'—went unheeded. [28]

India's approach to the whole idea of recognition was a mixture of emotionalism and conjecture. There was no strategy. The timing became the central point of the exercise. This too was determined by the international calendar rather than by India's national interests. The Commonwealth Foreign Ministers Conference was to be held in Colombo in mid-January 1950. Nehru decided that India should recognize the People's Republic of China before the other members of the Commonwealth. It was accordingly decided to do so on 30 December 1949.

When Zhou Enlai received Nehru's telegram of India's decision to recognize the People's Republic of China, he consulted Mao Zedong, who was on a secret visit to Moscow, and informed Nehru on 4 January 1950 of China's willingness to establish relations on the basis of equality, mutual benefit and mutual respect for territorial sovereignty. They added one caveat. Zhou proposed that the Government of China expected the representative of India to travel to Beijing to negotiate on the matter of formal establishment of diplomatic relations. [29] It became apparent to the Government of India that their original presumption, that recognition of the new regime in China in and of itself would automatically mean the establishment of diplomatic relations, was not correct. The Chinese wanted to negotiate formally. They also wanted the negotiation to be in China, which was unusual since the Chinese were the supplicants. India ought to have asked China to send their representative to Delhi for this purpose. A.K. Sen, the Indian liaison officer in China, had also informed the government that the Soviet bloc countries were not being asked to follow a similar practice of going to Beijing for negotiations. Thus, Chinese actions vis-à-vis India did not appear to speak the